

HELIOLITE · DESIGN DECISION RECORD

HelioLite TRL 2 review decisions

Open Hardware Portfolio · amishchadha.com

DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/heliolite		
Source	docs/decisions/0001-trl2-review-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.1	2026-09-25	Amish Chadha	Record Amish's decisions on the TRL 2 review items and the items that remain open

0001: TRL 2 review decisions

- **Date:** 2026-09-25
- **Status:** accepted for items D1 to D10; items O1 to O4 remain proposed

■ Context

The TRL 2 review note (docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25, /populate) listed eleven items as "Proposed, awaiting Amish". Ten carried a recommendation. On 2026-09-25 Amish reviewed the review points for every portfolio repo and wrote: "proceed with all of your recommendations across all batches. Make sure we don't proceed to TRL 4 on any of them." Every item that carried a recommendation is therefore decided in favor of that recommendation. Items without a recommendation stay open.

The same instruction approved portfolio-wide decisions on the SwapCell interface (a wake method for hosts without CAN, a charge-while-discharging mode and a latch vibration rating) and on pricing shared SwapCell packs once. HelioLite runs from a listed indoor 12 V adapter and uses no SwapCell pack, so these do not change this design. The instruction also leaves co-design partners open for community designs; HelioLite's first site and user (O1) stays open accordingly.

■ Options considered

The options for each item are those listed in docs/REVIEW.md (TRL 2 session) and in HLT-PRC-001 v0.2, Key design choices.

■ Decision

Table 1. Decided items.

#	Item	Decision
D1	Mast	60.3 mm (2 in) galvanized steel pipe (Option A), rather than an 80 x 80 mm extrusion or a guyed 40 x 40 mm extrusion. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D2	Storm awareness (R9)	Wi-Fi wind forecast plus a low-cost cup anemometer (Options A and B), with the anemometer counted as a weather sensor, not a tracking sensor, and costed in the BOM. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D3	Safe state on power loss (R10)	Supercapacitor stow reserve that finishes a face-down stow (Option A). Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D4	Budget	Raise <code>budget_usd</code> from \$400 to \$430 (option a), because the fixes for R9 and R10 are safety items. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D5	Pitch wording	Change "with no sensors" to "with no sun sensors". Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D6	Stow attitude	Face-down stow at night, on faults and before storms, rather than face-up or edge-on. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D7	Calibration	Jog the sun spot onto the target at three or more times of day and fit the mount model, rather than a compass, inclinometer or GPS survey. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D8	Sun-position algorithm	Grena algorithm 5 at 30 s updates, NREL SPA as an alternative, with weekly network time when Wi-Fi is available. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D9	Power supply	Listed indoor 12 V adapter with only SELV cable outdoors, rather than a solar panel and battery on the mast. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.
D10	Mirror	Glass mirror with a safety backing film, rather than acrylic or aluminum-film mirror. Decided by Amish, 2026-09-25: go with recommendation.

Notes on the decided items:

- **D4.** `project.yaml` now carries `budget_usd: 430`, and requirement R15 reads "\$430 or less". The TRL 3 BOM totals \$425 (HLT-CAL-001, section J).
- **D5.** Applied to `project.yaml` and `README.md`. The design uses two axis homing Hall switches and, after D2, an anemometer; neither senses the sun.
- **D7.** HLT-CAL-001 (section D) finds that three points over about 3 h leave a 95th percentile residual of about 0.45° on the mirror normal, and four points over about 4 h about 0.23°. The decision allows "three or more"; four points over about 4 h are used in the pointing budget.

Table 2. Items that remain open (Proposed, awaiting Amish).

#	Item	Why it stays open
O1	First site and user for the co-design checklist (house, greenhouse or school)	No recommendation was made; needs Amish. Co-design partners stay open by Amish's instruction
O2	Local rules on glare and structures at the first site	Depends on O1
O3	Siting survey of real yards (how often a mirror can see both the winter sun and a north window)	Listed as an open question with no recommendation
O4	New TRL 3 proposals: stowed wind survival (R9), mass limit (R13), drive preload (R4), calibration time wording (R7), transient beam path in a stow (R10)	Raised by HLT-CAL-001 after the decision; see docs/REVIEW.md , session 2026-09-25: TRL 3

■ Consequences

- The BOM gains an anemometer (line 14) and a supercapacitor stow reserve (line 15); the drives become NEMA17 motors on NMRV030-class 50:1 worm gearboxes with a listed rating, so the holding torque question in R9 can be checked.
- HLT-PRB-001, HLT-PRC-001 and HLT-REQ-001 move to v0.3 with these choices recorded as decided.
- TRL 4 work stays on hold by Amish's instruction.